STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			G-9700
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 11/17/08	DATE REVISED **07/30/21**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE GENERAL	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT PROJECT LIFESAVER	CROSS REFERENCE P-5100 MISSING PERSONS/JUVENILES			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish guidelines for placing citizens into the Project Lifesaver Program, monitoring those citizens, and locating them when lost.

II. Policy:

The Sarpy County Sheriff's Office is committed to the safety of all persons within the county and recognizes that some individuals, due to medical conditions (e.g. Alzheimer's disease, Autism, etc.), may be at risk to wander away from either a home or care facility. It is therefore incumbent upon the Sheriff's Office to provide for those families the most up to date equipment to minimize the risk to those individuals. Personnel assigned and trained in the use of the Project Lifesaver Tracking Equipment shall be responsible for responding when activated to help search for and locate clients of the Project Lifesaver Program. Additionally, these deputies shall have the responsibility to enroll clients into the program and continue with battery changes and maintenance records as needed throughout the time the client is enrolled in the program.

The Sarpy County Sheriff's Office shall also provide this service to other law enforcement agencies in the county and will respond when requested to those jurisdictions to assist with locating a missing person enrolled in the program.

III. Definitions:

A. RECEIVER : A Mobile locator Unit that can track up to 200 separate frequencies.

B. PROJECT LIFESAVER COORDINATOR: Sheriff's Office employee assigned by the Sheriff to review and approve applications for the Project Lifesaver Program, coordinate placement into and removal from the program, coordinate training for other employees, and coordinate search efforts when requested.

C. PROJECT LIFESAVER DEPUTY: Sheriff's Office deputies trained to place individuals into the program, remove individuals from the program, and track missing clients.

D. WRISTBAND TRANSMITTER : A transmitter that will pulse or emit a radio signal approximately once every second.

IV. Procedures:

A. Guidelines for Client Application:

1. The following individuals may apply to be placed in the Project Life Saver Program:

a) Persons that are suffering with Alzheimer's disease, dementia and other related mental dysfunction disorders or injuries that may be at risk wandering from a caregiver.

b) Persons who are afflicted with Down syndrome, Autism, or other illness or injury that may place him or her at risk to wander.

2. Clients must have a twenty-four (24) hour caregiver who can check the batteries and report immediately to the Sarpy County dispatch center if the client wanders.

3. Transmitters shall be placed with clients only at the request of a legally responsible party, including:

a) Spouse.
b) Son or daughter, in the absence of a spouse.
c) Family member having legal, primary caregiver responsibility.
d) Assisted living or nursing home administrator requiring a transmitter for client to reside at the facility.
e) Father or Mother, if client is a minor.
f) In the event there is no spouse and there is a disagreement on placement, no placement shall be done until requested by the family member having legal authority via power of attorney or court order naming him or her as the responsible caregiver.

B. Client Placement and Removal from Project Lifesaver Program:

1. After receiving an inquiry from a caregiver regarding an individual meeting the above criteria, the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office Project Lifesaver Coordinator shall provide the caregiver with program information and a copy of the Project Lifesaver contract.

2. If the caregiver wishes to have the individual placed on the program, the Project Lifesaver Coordinator shall assign a Project Lifesaver deputy to meet with the family or caregiver of a potential client and discuss the Project Lifesaver Program.

3. Once the family or caregiver has signed a Sarpy County Sheriff's Office Project Lifesaver contract, which gives the Sheriff's Office permission to fit the new client with a transmitter, a Project Lifesaver deputy will fit the new client with a wristband transmitter. The family member or caregiver will be given a transmitter tester and instructed how to use the transmitter tester and how to complete the Battery/Transmitter Test Log. The assigned Project Lifesaver deputy shall complete a Client Profile and enter the information into the Lifesaver Management Database.

4. When a family member or caregiver requests to have the client removed from the program, the assigned Project Lifesaver deputy will remove the transmitter from the client and retrieve all equipment.

5. Family members or Caregivers may be responsible for the cost of equipment replacement and for any damaged or lost equipment belonging to the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office Project Lifesaver Program.

C. **Search Guidelines:** The following procedures shall be adhered to when a search is conducted for a missing Project Lifesaver client.

1. Electronic receiver and equipment shall be stored at the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office for use by Project Lifesaver deputies.

2. When Sarpy County Communications receives a call regarding a missing Project Lifesaver client, road patrol units shall be dispatched.

3. The on-scene road patrol deputies shall conduct an investigation regarding the missing individual. After confirmation that the individual is not at the location and is currently a client of Project Lifesaver, the shift supervisor shall be notified. Deputies should also obtain information regarding where the individual was last seen and what he or she was last seen wearing.

4. The shift supervisor shall notify Communications and request the Project Lifesaver Coordinator be contacted. The shift supervisor shall also notify the on-duty watch commander or the ADC. The shift supervisor shall respond to the scene, if possible.

5. Communications shall contact Project Lifesaver Response Team members starting with the Project Lifesaver Coordinator. After contacting the Project Lifesaver Coordinator, Communications shall contact the assigned Project

Lifesaver deputy and the Commander of the Sheriff's Office Search and Rescue Team (SART) to respond to coordinate the search

6. One of the Project Lifesaver deputies shall respond to the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office to retrieve the Project Lifesaver Search Equipment and will then respond to the scene.

7. Upon arrival of at least two Project Lifesaver deputies, they shall conduct an electronically assisted search. The highest ranking or most senior Project Lifesaver deputy shall be responsible for the search unless he or she is relieved by a superior command officer. Other deputies and SART members on scene shall assist the search as directed by the Project Lifesaver deputies.

8. Only Project Lifesaver deputies shall utilize tracking equipment.

9. If needed, additional Project Lifesaver personnel from other law enforcement agencies within the county may be requested to assist with the search. A shift supervisor, command officer, or Project Lifesaver deputy may make this request.

10. Upon locating the missing client, the shift supervisor or ranking deputy at the scene shall determine if medical treatment and/or transport home are appropriate and ensure its completion.

11. The shift supervisor or a command officer shall determine when a search is to be terminated after consulting with all available team members at the scene.

12. The originally assigned road patrol deputy shall complete an Incident Report upon completion of the search. The Incident Commander shall also complete a supplemental report regarding the specific search activities.

D. Maintenance Procedure for Project Lifesaver Equipment:

1. Project Lifesaver deputies assigned by the Project Lifesaver Coordinator shall complete maintenance checks on all transmitters that belong to the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office Project Lifesaver Program**.**

2. Batteries shall be replaced in each transmitter every sixty (60) days from the date of installation. Bands shall also be replaced and adjusted at this time, as needed.

3. At the sixty (60) day inspection, transmitters shall be checked with a Transmitter Tester and receiver to insure that they are functioning properly.

The transmitter shall be tested inside the residence and outside the residence.

4. All monthly maintenance of equipment shall be documented on the Monthly Inspection/Replacement log.

E. Project Lifesaver Program Coordinator Responsibilities:

1. The Projector Lifesaver Coordinator shall be responsible for assigning potential clients for the program to a Project Lifesaver deputy.

2. The Projector Lifesaver Coordinator shall maintain all records including, but not limited to, applications, contracts, logs, client profiles, and after action reports.

3. The Projector Lifesaver Coordinator shall ensure that all new client information is placed into the Project Lifesaver management database.

4. The Projector Lifesaver Coordinator shall provide Communications with an updated client list including name, address, caregiver name and assigned frequency number. The Projector Lifesaver Coordinator shall also provide Communications a Project Lifesaver deputy call out list.

5. The Projector Lifesaver Coordinator shall check the receiver equipment monthly to ensure it is functioning properly and that batteries are charged. This shall be documented on the Project Lifesaver Maintenance log.

F. Project Life Saver Funding:

1. Any donations received shall be given to the Office Manager for deposit into the Sarpy County Project Lifesaver account set up with Project Lifesaver International.

2. Funds generated shall only be used for the purchase, maintenance, or replacement of Project Lifesaver equipment.

3. Donations that are made from civic organizations, businesses or private individuals shall also be deposited into the Sarpy County Project Lifesaver fund. These funds shall be used to make purchases needed to continue the program.

4. Funds may also be donated through the Sheriff's Office Foundation.